

ChangeLoop

Concept Note

1. Title page

Startup name	ChangeLoop
Tagline	Cut the water by a fifth. Burn exactly the same fuel.
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Working prototype	https://changeloop-water-intelligence.onrender.com

2. Background and problem statement

Context

Tirupur in Tamil Nadu is India's knitwear capital. In the year to March 2026 it exported around Rs 46,000 crore of knitwear, more than half of everything India sells abroad in cotton knitwear. Its dyeing factories sit on the Noyyal river.

In 2011 the Madras High Court shut around 700 dyeing and bleaching units for putting salty waste water into the river. They were allowed back only if they stopped releasing liquid waste completely. The rule is called zero liquid discharge, or ZLD.

Today about 300 dyeing units run on 18 shared treatment plants, and another 60 have their own. Between them they recycle about 120 million litres of water a day and recover around 94% of it. Reported unit counts vary between sources, from roughly 360 to 450, so I treat the cluster as a few hundred units rather than a precise number.

It worked for the river. The waste water stopped going in. But the problem moved to the boiler house, and nobody is managing it.

The problem

To recycle the water, a factory has to boil the leftover salty stream until only dry salt is left. Boiling needs heat and the heat comes from steam. Energy audits of more than sixty dyeing units in Tiruppur during 2024 and early 2025 found each one burning about 2,000 tonnes of solid fuel a year, primarily wood, with coal and briquettes also in use. Boiling one cubic metre of leftover takes about 188 kWh of heat.

One caveat I want up front rather than buried. The rupee and carbon figures in this note are derived on a coal-fired basis, which is what my coefficient registry states.

A wood-fired boiler has different fuel economics and a different carbon profile, so those two conversions need re-deriving for any particular site. The physics underneath does not move: salt sets how much has to be boiled whatever fuel raises the steam.

Here is the part almost nobody acts on.

The amount you have to boil is fixed by the salt, not by the water.

leftover volume = salt mass / strongest the membranes can make it

Water goes round the loop and comes back. Salt does not. Salt has to leave as a solid, and the only way out is through the evaporator. So the evaporator must boil whatever amount of water that salt happens to be sitting in.

The result is easy to test, and my system tests it on every request:

Change a factory makes	What happens to evaporator energy
Uses 20% less water	no change at all
Puts in 20% less salt	20% less energy

Zero, not a small amount. It falls straight out of the arithmetic.

So two changes that look identical on a water meter do completely different things to the fuel bill. Most water-saving work in the cluster aims at the water. It does not touch the fuel.

Why a problem this simple is still not solved

It is fair to ask why, if the arithmetic is this plain, a cluster that exports Rs 46,000 crore a year has not already fixed it. The honest answer is that the saving is not hidden. It is known, documented, and still not taken.

Energy audits of more than sixty dyeing units in Tiruppur during 2024 and early 2025 found that simple efficiency measures could cut about **15% of fuel consumption**. Many of those measures needed little or no investment. Adoption stayed low anyway.

That is the real problem, and it is not a technical one. Four things keep it in place.

An audit produces a report, not a decision. A consultant visits, measures, writes it up and leaves. On Monday the planner schedules the day exactly as before, because nothing in their actual workflow changed. Reports do not run shifts.

Changing anything feels like risking production. The audits name fear of disrupting production as a barrier even for measures that cost nothing. In a job-work cluster running to tight delivery dates, a late or off-shade lot costs far more than the fuel it might have saved. Any proposal that cannot guarantee the ship date is dead on arrival, however good its numbers are.

The person who decides does not see the bill. The salt load is set by a production planner choosing which lots run in what order and which rinse method to use. They make that call hours before anything shows up. The fuel bill arrives weeks later, in a different department's budget, with no way to trace it back. The planner is not being careless. They are working without the one number that would change their mind.

Nobody meters the thing that matters. Water is metered because it is billed and regulated. Salt is bought by the sack and dissolved into a bath, and no Indian dyehouse I can find reports salt load per lot. What is not measured does not get managed, and here the unmeasured variable is the one driving the cost.

So the gap is not knowledge. It is that no tool puts the consequence in front of the person making the choice, at the moment they make it, without asking them to risk a delivery.

There is a second problem one level up. A factory runs several dyeing machines into one shared evaporator. Each planner picks what is best for their own machine, and every choice is correct on its own. Added together they can still be more than the evaporator can boil. In my model four machines each picking their own best plan put the shared evaporator at **121.9% of what it can handle**. No tool that looks at one machine can see this.

Target audience

The people most affected are the ones running these factories under a rule they did not choose and cannot opt out of.

Who	Why this matters to them
Production planners in Tirupur dyeing units	They make this decision every shift and cannot see what it costs
Factory owners	They pay a fuel bill they cannot trace or control
The 18 shared treatment plants	They buy the steam and store the salt. Somewhere between 60,000 and 73,000 tonnes of waste salt has built up across them, with no settled disposal route
Households and farmers in the Noyyal basin	Groundwater here is heavily stressed. Every litre not pulled out matters more than a litre saved somewhere easy

3. Vision and mission

Vision

Every closed water loop in Indian industry is run on what it actually costs, not on what is easy to measure.

Water meters are everywhere and they measure the wrong thing. In a closed loop the environmental and financial damage is driven by dissolved load, and almost nothing in industry is set up to see that. The long-term aim is to make the hidden number visible wherever this physics applies, starting with textiles and extending to cooling towers, boiler blowdown and other closed systems.

Mission

Put the downstream cost in front of the person making the upstream decision, at the moment they make it, with every number open to inspection.

In practice that means three things. Build the decision layer and prove the physics. Prove it on one factory with real instruments. Then reach the rest of the cluster through the shared treatment plants, whose own economics already point the same way.

4. Solution overview

What it does, in one paragraph

ChangeLoop sits where the schedule is made. Before a shift starts, it takes the lots that have to run and works out every order they could run in, and every rinse method available for each. For each of those combinations it computes the full consequence: water drawn, salt added, leftover volume to boil, evaporator steam, CO₂ and rupees, and whether any delivery date would be missed. It throws away everything that ships late, ranks what is left, and shows the planner the best plan with its working.

The planner can accept it or ignore it. Nothing else changes: no new equipment, no new chemistry, no change to who approves what.

Why this is the right place to intervene

Every other way of attacking this problem asks the factory to change something physical, and that is why they stall.

Buy a better evaporator and you have spent capital on treating the symptom. Buy low-salt chemistry and you have raised the cost per kilogram today for a fuel saving you cannot yet see. Run an energy audit and you get a report. All three ask for money or risk up front against a benefit nobody has measured.

Changing the order lots run in costs nothing, risks nothing, and is reversible the same day. It is the only lever in this process that is free to pull. What I have added is making it a visible lever rather than an invisible one.

What makes it different

One line, if you only read one. Every planning tool in a dyehouse optimises for throughput and delivery. ChangeLoop is the only one that prices what the schedule does to the boiler, and it does that while the schedule is still being chosen.

The rest follows from treating that as a safety-critical decision rather than a dashboard.

	How ChangeLoop behaves	Why it matters here
Delivery dates	A plan that ships late is deleted from the search, not scored badly	Removes the single objection that kills every efficiency proposal in a job-work cluster
Every input number	All 25 are labelled published, derived, assumed or measured, with the source and the arithmetic, readable in the live system	A process engineer can audit the model instead of trusting it. None is MEASURED yet and a test enforces that
Authority	Issues no machine settings and cannot release a dye bath. Early release needs a named person	The quality supervisor keeps the decision that carries the quality risk
Bad sensor data	Holds and claims zero saving rather than estimating	An advisory tool that quietly guesses is worse than no tool
Credit for savings	A recommendation the planner declines counts as zero, even though the engine computed it	The ledger records what was done, not what was advised, so it can be billed against
More than one machine	Compares what each machine would pick alone against the cheapest combination the shared evaporator can take	Four locally correct choices can still breach the plant, and no single-machine tool can see it

Value proposition

Who	What they get
Factory owner	Lower fuel and water bills from a scheduling change, with nothing to buy and no change to the approval process
Production planner	The missing number on their screen, at the moment they need it, with the ship date protected by construction
Shared treatment plant	Less salt arriving, so less steam bought and less solid salt stored
Regulator or tariff-setter	A figure for what a price change would actually do, instead of an argument in principle

5. Objectives and goals

Short term, the next 12 months

Objective	Measure of success
Install instruments at one pilot factory	Steam flow and reject conductivity metered for 28 days at over 95% completeness
Prove the recommendations are sound	Planner agrees with over 60% of them unprompted, during four weeks where the tool changes nothing
Measure a real saving	Water and steam reduction measured with a confidence interval, on alternate weeks on and off
Keep quality intact	Zero colour-fastness failures attributable to an approved plan
Turn assumptions into measurements	Move the two heaviest input numbers from published to measured

Long term, two to five years

The first two are the ones that matter. They change the cluster whether or not anyone buys the software.

Objective	Target	Why it has leverage
Get treatment plants to charge by salt, not by volume	One CETP piloting a salt-indexed tariff for its members	Today a member unit pays the same whether it sends clean water or brine, so the cost of the salt it created lands on the plant. Change that and every member has the incentive on day one, whether or not anyone buys my software. This is the single highest-leverage outcome in the project
Make salt load per lot a number the industry reports	Salt per lot metered and reported at 40 units, the way water already is	Water got managed once it got metered. Nothing gets managed until it is measured, and right now nobody measures the variable that drives the cost
Close the dye premium gap by buying together	A joint procurement approach across CETP members, aimed at the 12% gap my engine measured	12% is small enough that aggregated demand across a few hundred units could close it. Then the 47% plan becomes the cheap plan and nobody has to be persuaded
Solve cluster coordination properly	A method that works for hundreds of member units, not the 256 combinations the current solver checks exhaustively	The current approach is proven but will not scale, and I would rather say that than imply it will

Objective	Target	Why it has leverage
Put the evidence in the open	The measured coefficients published, with the method, for anyone to use or contest	A model nobody can check is worth less than one people argue with
Extend beyond textiles	One validated application in another closed-loop system, such as evaporative cooling	The physics is not specific to dyeing, but it is unproven anywhere else

6. Business model

How it makes money

A share of the saving the system can prove, plus a small one-off fee to connect it.

Item	Amount
Share of verified saving	25%
One-off setup	Rs 75,000 per unit

No licence fee and no charge for the software itself. If the tool saves a factory nothing, it costs that factory nothing beyond the setup.

The setup fee is engineering time, not margin. Roughly six to eight days of work at Indian specialist rates:

What the setup fee pays for	Amount
Getting the lot schedule out of the planning system and into a usable feed	Rs 25,000
Interfacing the existing meters and tagging which stream is which	Rs 20,000
Setting the coefficient registry to the site's own tariffs, machines and shade book	Rs 15,000
Training the planner and the quality supervisor, and sitting with them for the first week	Rs 15,000
Total	Rs 75,000

It does not include instruments. A site that already meters steam and reject conductivity needs none. A site that does not can either add them, at about Rs 1,75,000 as broken down in section 9, or run on published coefficients and accept that the saving is estimated rather than measured. I would rather be clear about that than bundle hardware into a software price.

Why charge this way

A flat subscription was my first instinct and I dropped it. A fixed fee charges the same whether the system saves a factory a lot or nothing at all, and asks a thin-margin dyeing unit to take that risk on a saving that is modelled rather than measured. No one should sign that, and I would not pitch it.

The share model fits what is already built. The system computes every saving on the server, counts only what a named person actually approved, and writes it to a tamper-evident ledger. That ledger is a billing basis, not just an audit trail. It also turns the project's weakest point into the mechanism: nothing has been measured yet, so nothing is owed yet.

What a factory actually gets

The engine reports a net saving per machine-shift against a conventional single-stage rinse. A unit running 9,000 lots a year at five lots a shift is 1,800 machine-shifts, so the annual figure is that number multiplied out.

	Plan it recommends today	Low-salt plan
Net saving per machine-shift	Rs 7,860	Rs 3,914
Machine-shifts a year	1,800	1,800
Net saving a year	Rs 1,41,47,000	Rs 70,45,000
My 25% share	Rs 35,37,000	Rs 17,61,000
Water and steam cut	6%	47%

Read that table carefully, because it is the point of the whole project.

The plan the optimiser recommends today saves **more money** and almost no water. The low-salt plan saves **less money** and nearly half the water and steam. The dye premium eats most of the saving, which is exactly why a profit-seeking factory does not buy it and why the cluster keeps burning fuel it does not need to.

Close the 12% gap in the dye premium and the low-salt plan becomes the cheaper one too. Then the factory saves more money and more water at the same time, and nobody has to be persuaded to choose between them.

Two caveats, and the second is the one I would raise first if I were reviewing this.

The absolute rupees are modelled, on a modelled order book of five lots. The direction and the ranking are what I would defend; a pilot establishes the rest.

More importantly, the baseline here is a conventional single-stage rinse, and counter-current cascade is an established best available technique. Any unit already running it has already taken that 6%, and ChangeLoop will not find it again. For those units the value is not the rinse method at all. It is the sequencing decision, the salt visibility, and the 12% finding on the dye premium, none of

which depends on the rinse baseline. The first thing a pilot does in week one is establish which kind of unit it is in, because that determines what is left to save.

How customers are reached

Through the shared treatment plants. Tirupur has 18 of them serving about 300 units. One commercial relationship reaches roughly 17 factories, which cuts the cost of selling by an order of magnitude compared with knocking on doors.

The treatment plants also want this for their own reasons. Less salt arriving means less steam bought and less salt stored. That makes them a partner rather than just a channel.

Through running silently first. Four weeks of being right while changing nothing is how a tool earns the right to influence a factory's decisions. It costs the factory nothing.

Through trade bodies. The Tiruppur Exporters Association and the dyers' associations already coordinate on environmental compliance, which is the exact context this belongs in.

Partnerships that would help

Partner	What it brings
A shared treatment plant in Tirupur	The pilot site, the steam data, and the route to its member units
A dye chemistry supplier	Real pricing on low-salt chemistry, which is the lever with the smallest gap to close
A state pollution control board or CPCB	Credibility, and access to the measured data that would replace my published figures
An academic water or chemical engineering group	Independent review of the model before anyone relies on it

7. Market analysis and competition

Market size

Level	Size	Basis
Tirupur, immediate	About 360 dyeing units. A 25% share of the modelled saving would be of the order of Rs 100 crore a year across the cluster	300 units on 18 CETPs plus 60 with their own plants, other reports nearer 450. This rests entirely on the modelled per-shift saving holding at real sites, which no pilot has yet tested. Treat it as an order of magnitude, not a forecast

Level	Size	Basis
Indian textile ZLD, wider	Tirupur is one of several clusters under ZLD rules. Surat, Erode, Karur, Ludhiana, Panipat and Jetpur have similar processing bases. The whole Indian ZLD equipment market across all industries is put at about USD 1.33 billion in 2025 , growing to USD 2.52 billion by 2032	The dollar figure is a commercial market estimate covering all ZLD, not textile software. I have not counted dyeing units outside Tirupur and will not present a number I cannot source
Adjacent closed loops, later	Evaporative cooling, boiler blowdown and mine water share the same physics	Unvalidated. Listed as direction, not as market

The growth driver is regulation that already exists. ZLD is compulsory and already paid for. ChangeLoop does not ask anyone to install new equipment, it makes equipment they already own cheaper to run.

The second driver is carbon reporting. European buyers increasingly ask Indian suppliers for emissions data. The EU carbon border mechanism does not cover textiles today, since it applies to iron and steel, cement, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, but textiles have been named as a candidate for a later phase. If that happens, a tool that can show measured and traceable reductions in process emissions becomes a compliance asset as well as a cost saver. I am treating that as a possible tailwind, not as a commitment anyone has made.

Competitive landscape

Who	What they do	Why ChangeLoop is different
Dyehouse software , such as SedoMaster and Datatex	Plan production, manage recipes, track batches	They schedule for throughput and delivery. Neither prices the downstream thermal cost of the schedule, which is the whole point here
ZLD equipment companies , such as Praj and VA Tech Wabag	Build and run the membranes and evaporators. Praj has worked on Tirupur textile effluent; VA Tech Wabag builds evaporator-based ZLD plants	They sell the plant. They do not touch the upstream decision that sets how hard the plant has to work
Water monitoring and IoT dashboards	Report flows and quality after the fact	They measure water volume, which the table in section 2 shows is the wrong number for the fuel bill

Who	What they do	Why ChangeLoop is different
Low-salt dye chemistry , such as Archroma's Avitera range, and CIRCOT's low-salt dyeing work in India	Sell or license the chemistry that cuts salt	They sell the lever. They cannot tell a factory when it pays, which is exactly what my system computes
Consultancies and energy audits	One-off studies	A report is read once. This runs every shift and is checked against what was actually approved

The honest summary: the pieces exist. The membranes exist, the chemistry exists, the planning software exists. What does not exist is anything that connects the upstream scheduling decision to the downstream fuel bill, which is where the saving is hiding.

8. Implementation plan

Current status

The prototype is built and running. It is a live system anyone can open, not a mockup.

API	34 endpoints. Every saving is worked out on the server, so the browser cannot claim one
Tests	180, covering the physics, the safety rules, concurrency and the interface
Input numbers	25, each labelled with its source. 17 published, 4 derived, 4 assumed, 0 measured
Validation	Fed the water strength CPCB measured at a Tirupur unit, 18,340 mg/L, the model predicted 30.6% leftover. Indian plants report 20 to 30%

Timeline

Stage	Weeks	What happens	Gate to pass
1. Measure the baseline	1-4	Instruments installed. Nothing changes on the floor	28 days of data at over 95% completeness
2. Run it silently	5-8	The tool recommends, nobody acts	Planner agrees with over 60% unprompted
3. Planner may approve	9-16	Reordering only, no chemistry change	Measured water reduction, zero off-shade lots

Stage	Weeks	What happens	Gate to pass
4. Early release trial	17-24	Quality supervisor may allow early wash-off release	Every released lot lab tested. One failure ends the trial
5. Decide on chemistry	25-32	With steam cost now measured, decide if low-salt dye pays	A decision backed by measured, not assumed, numbers
6. More factories	33-52	Second and third unit on the same treatment plant	Two more units live and paying

The weeks run on and off in alternate blocks, so the comparison is against the same season, the same order mix and the same crew. The whole point is to answer one question: did the tool cause the saving, or would it have happened anyway?

Key milestones

Milestone	When
First pilot site signed	Month 1
First measured coefficient, replacing a published one	Month 2
First saving measured with a confidence interval	Month 6
First paying customer beyond the pilot	Month 10
Cluster coordination working across one CETP	Month 18
40 paying units	Month 36

9. Financial overview

All figures in this section are plans, not results. I have no revenue and no customers today. The software already exists and runs, so what follows is the cost of proving it on a real factory, not the cost of building it.

What the pilot actually costs

Instrumentation per site. These are the two readings that turn the heaviest assumptions in the model into measurements.

Item	Cost	Why this figure
Vortex steam flow meter, DN50, steam rated	Rs 60,000	Indian suppliers quote Rs 35,500 to Rs 96,000 depending on line size and specification

Item	Cost	Why this figure
Inductive conductivity transmitter and sensor	Rs 50,000	The reject stream fouls contacting electrodes, so an inductive probe is the correct type. Indian industrial units run Rs 25,000 to Rs 60,000
Tapping, wiring and commissioning	Rs 35,000	Hot line tapping and a safe install on an existing steam header
Data logger and gateway	Rs 15,000	So readings reach the system without someone copying them down
Calibration and first-year checks	Rs 15,000	A drifting sensor is worse than no sensor
Per site	Rs 1,75,000	

The whole pilot across twelve months, for two sites.

Item	Cost	Why this figure
Instrumentation, two sites	Rs 3,50,000	Two sites so the result is not one factory's quirk
Independent colour-fastness testing	Rs 50,000	About 150 samples. SITRA in Coimbatore publishes Rs 300 to Rs 350 per sample for colour fastness to washing
Travel to Tirupur, about twelve visits	Rs 60,000	About Rs 5,000 a visit including travel and a night's stay. Install, calibrate, and sit with the planner during the shadow weeks
Cloud hosting and domain	Rs 20,000	The system runs on a small instance today
Contingency, about 10%	Rs 48,000	
Total	Rs 5,28,000	

What costs nothing

The software is built, tested and running. Extending it to a second or third factory is configuration, not development.

The host factory contributes in kind rather than in cash: access to the steam header and the reject line, an extract from its planning system, and some of the planner's time during the weeks when the tool changes nothing. None of that is a cheque, and without it the cash above buys nothing.

My own work on the pilot is not costed here. I am doing it either way.

How a pilot like this gets funded

Three routes, and they are not exclusive. A treatment plant can co-fund the instruments, because the steam saving lands on its own bill. A state or central scheme for cluster-level environmental work can cover metering. Or the first site pays a reduced fee and keeps the saving, which is the cleanest test of whether anyone actually wants this.

I am not putting a funding request in this note. The number above is here so the cost of the next step is visible, and because a plan that cannot say what it costs is not a plan.

Unit economics, once it is selling

Item	Amount
Share of verified saving	25%
One-off setup	Rs 75,000 per unit
Share per unit at the modelled saving	of the order of Rs 35,00,000 a year

That per-unit figure is large and it rests on a modelled order book. I am carrying it forward because it is what my own engine says, not because I believe it to the rupee. The first pilot replaces it with a measured number, and the share model means I am paid on that measured number rather than on this one.

Revenue projections

These assume the pilot succeeds, the treatment plant channel works, and the modelled per-shift saving survives contact with a real site. All three are assumptions, and the third is the weakest: a unit already running counter-current rinsing has less to gain, and I do not yet know how many of Tirupur's units that is. To keep the projection cautious I have priced the share at a fifth of the modelled figure, around Rs 7,00,000 a unit a year, because I would rather under-promise a number no instrument has confirmed.

	Year 1	Year 2	Year 3
Live units	2, pilot	12	40
Setup revenue, new units only	Rs 1,50,000	Rs 7,50,000	Rs 21,00,000
Share of verified saving, at Rs 7,00,000 a unit	waived during pilot	Rs 84,00,000	Rs 2,80,00,000
Total revenue	Rs 1,50,000	Rs 91,50,000	Rs 3,01,00,000

Year 1 is a pilot year and is not meant to make money; the share is waived while the baseline is still being established. Years 2 and 3 assume one CETP relationship

in year 2 and two or three by year 3, at about 17 member units each.

Setup is billed once per unit, on new units only, so year 2 bills ten and year 3 bills twenty-eight, not forty. The share is billed on every live unit against what the ledger says was actually saved, so if the measured saving comes in below the model, the revenue falls with it automatically.

10. Impact assessment

If one factory adopts it

Per shift, on the plan the tool recommends under today's prices, against a conventional single-stage rinse:

	Fresh water	Evaporator steam	Cost
Baseline	11,907 L	2,239 kWh	Rs 33,897
Recommended today	11,187 L (-6%)	2,104 kWh (-6%)	Rs 26,038
Available with low-salt chemistry	6,369 L (-47%)	1,198 kWh (-47%)	Rs 29,984

If the cluster adopts it

A straight-line projection across 400 units at 900 lots each a year. The 400 is the figure my engine uses; it sits between the 360 counted earlier and the 450 other reports give, so it is a reasonable stand-in for the cluster rather than a separate claim. This is a projection and my system labels it as one. It assumes every factory resembles the modelled one and that every recommendation is approved. Neither has been tested, and it must not be read as achieved impact.

Saved per year across the cluster	
Fresh water	75 million litres
Salt	4,500 tonnes
Evaporator steam	14,106 MWh
CO2	6,376 tonnes

Environmental benefit

Less groundwater pulled out of a basin that is already stressed. Less solid fuel burned for the same output, which in Tiruppur mostly means less wood. Less solid salt added to the 60,000 to 73,000 tonnes already stockpiled across Tiruppur's treatment plants with no settled disposal route.

Economic benefit

A lower cost base for a cluster that exports around Rs 46,000 crore a year and competes on price. The 2011 shutdown is living memory in Tirupur, so anything that strengthens environmental compliance also protects the jobs that depend on staying open.

The policy finding

My system can compute what price would make the bigger saving worth buying. It walks each price up or down, re-running the whole calculation at every step, and finds the point where a factory chasing profit picks the 47% plan on its own.

Price	Today	Changes at	Move needed
Low-salt dye premium	Rs 6.50/kg fabric	Rs 5.74/kg fabric	12% cheaper
Boiler steam	Rs 2.03/kWh heat	Rs 3.13/kWh heat	54% dearer
Fresh water	Rs 45/m3	Rs 251/m3	457% dearer

The steam row converts into a carbon price. Steam would need to rise Rs 1.09 per kWh of heat, and making that heat gives off 0.452 kg of CO₂, so the carbon price that produces the rise is **Rs 2,423 a tonne, about 21 euro**.

The EU carbon market was charging 82.40 euro a tonne on 5 October 2026, close to four times more. So this saving is not waiting for an impossible price. It is waiting for any price at all.

Three caveats travel with that figure. It assumes the whole carbon cost reaches the factory as a higher steam price, which is the best case. It is the point where this decision flips in my model, not a recommendation for what a carbon price ought to be. And it is computed on a coal-fired boiler, so at a wood-fired site the carbon lever is weaker and the dye premium matters more.

The dye premium and steam cost rows do not depend on the fuel at all. Whatever makes steam cost 54% more flips the decision, and a 12% fall in the dye premium flips it without touching the boiler. Those two findings stand whatever is burning, and they came out of the engine rather than out of an opinion.

11. Conclusion

ZLD saved the Noyyal river and left the cluster with a fuel bill nobody is managing. That bill is set by salt, not water, so most of the water-saving work in Tirupur is aimed at the wrong number. ChangeLoop shows the planner what their choice actually costs, at the moment they make it.

The prototype is built, running and open to inspection. The physics is checked against published plant measurements. A factory pays Rs 75,000 to connect and keeps three quarters of whatever the system can prove it saved, so it carries almost

no risk and I carry the rest. The route to the cluster runs through 18 shared treatment plants whose own economics already point the same way.

What it does not have is a single measured number from a real factory, and I would rather say that plainly than let a reviewer discover it. Closing that gap costs about Rs 5,28,000 and needs one factory willing to let me put two instruments on its pipework.

What would help most

None of these is money.

- **An introduction to a shared treatment plant** in Tirupur willing to host a pilot. This is the single thing standing between the project and its first measured number.
- **A technical review** of the model by someone who knows textile effluent. I would rather be told a coefficient is wrong now than after a factory has relied on it.
- **An introduction to a dye chemistry supplier**, to put a real price on the lever my system says has the smallest gap to close.

Next steps

I can demonstrate the live system in under ten minutes, including the parts that show its own limits. I would welcome a technical review of the coefficients before any pilot begins, and I am happy to be told a number is wrong. Every one of them is open at the link below.

<https://changeloop-water-intelligence.onrender.com>

12. Appendix

How the figures in this note can be checked

Every engine figure quoted here is produced by the live system and can be reproduced. The input numbers, with their sources and arithmetic, are at <https://changeloop-water-intelligence.onrender.com/api/evidence>

A script in the repository re-checks every number in this document against the engine and fails if any has drifted.

Evidence position

Label	How many	What it means
Published	17	From CPCB, the Central Electricity Authority, Tamil Nadu tariff orders, state pollution board data, the EU reference document, steam tables

Label	How many	What it means
Derived	4	Worked out from those by arithmetic a test re-checks
Assumed	4	My assumptions, labelled as such. All four are commercial prices public sources do not settle
Measured	0	No instrument on a real factory has fed this system. A test enforces this

What this project has not done

- No deployment, no customer, no pilot, no measured result.
- The baseline is a conventional single-stage rinse. Units already on counter-current cascade have taken that saving already, and I do not know what share of Tiruppur that is.
- The cluster figure is a projection, not achieved impact.
- The financial projections in section 9 are plans with stated assumptions. The pilot costs are built from quoted supplier and lab prices. The revenue figures rest on a modelled per-shift saving that no instrument has confirmed, and I have priced the projection at a fifth of it for that reason.
- The shared-evaporator solver checks every combination, which will not scale to a treatment plant with hundreds of members.
- The 60,000 mg/L limit is one modelled figure inside a published range of 15,000 to 80,000. Whether it holds in real running conditions is unknown.
- The rupee and carbon conversions assume a coal-fired boiler. Tiruppur units mostly burn wood, so both need re-deriving per site. The physics and the dye premium finding do not depend on the fuel.
- The data centre and cooling tower idea is an argument from structure, not a result.
- There is no trained model in this system and I do not call it AI-powered. The decision record is a hash chain, not a blockchain.

Sources

Figure	Where it comes from
Tiruppur exports of about Rs 46,000 crore in FY26	Tiruppur Exporters Association, reported March 2026
300 dyeing units on 18 CETPs, 60 with their own plants, 120 MLD recycled, 94% recovery	Reported cluster data, 2026. Other reports put the unit count nearer 450

Figure	Where it comes from
Waste salt backlog of 60,000 to 73,000 tonnes across the 18 CETPs	Dyers Association of Tiruppur, reported by Ecotextile News, 2022, and later reporting on accumulated salt at the CETPs
EU carbon border mechanism covers iron and steel, cement, aluminium, fertilisers, electricity and hydrogen, not textiles	European Commission scope; textiles named as a candidate for a later phase
Indian ZLD market of about USD 1.33 billion in 2025, USD 2.52 billion by 2032	MarkNtel Advisors, India Zero Liquid Discharge Market report. A commercial estimate, cited as such
Archroma Avitera SE reduced-salt reactive dye range	Ecotextile News, January 2024
Praj on Tirupur textile effluent; VA Tech Wabag on evaporator-based ZLD	Company and trade press reporting
2011 closure of around 700 units	Madras High Court order, widely reported
Tiruppur dyeing units burn about 2,000 tonnes of solid fuel a year each, primarily wood	Energy audits of more than sixty dyeing MSMEs in Tiruppur, 2024 to early 2025, reported by India Development Review
About 15% of fuel consumption available from simple efficiency measures, with adoption still low	The same energy audits of more than sixty Tiruppur dyeing MSMEs, 2024 to early 2025
Water strength of 18,340 mg/L, leftover at 20-30%, evaporator steam use	Central Pollution Control Board assessment of textile dyeing units and ZLD at Tirupur
Grid emissions, 0.705 kg CO ₂ per kWh	CO ₂ Baseline Database for the Indian Power Sector, Central Electricity Authority
Carbon price of 82.40 euro a tonne, 5 October 2026	European carbon prices, S&P Global Commodity Insights
Water and steam tariffs	Tamil Nadu Electricity Regulatory Commission tariff orders and state pollution board plant data
Latent heat, 0.62694 kWh/kg	Steam tables: 2,257 kJ/kg at 100 C and one atmosphere, divided by 3,600
Evaporator energy band, 150-250 kWh/m ³	EU Best Available Techniques reference document for textiles. Used as a check, never as an input